



From Discord to Harmony: Resources

Considerations for documentation



Be thorough and detailed.

Clearly describe the issue with specific examples. Focus on observable behaviors and outcomes. Record the date and time of each conversation, as well as any relevant incidents.



Be clear about goals.

Note the employee's perspective and any details they provide. Include any agreed-upon actions the employee needs to take to resolve the issue. Include a plan for follow-up meetings to review progress, as well as specific details about improvement responsibilities, and the consequences should those improvements not occur.



Be fair and objective.

Ensure that the documentation is kept confidential and only shared with those who need to know, such as Human Resources or your director. Keep the tone professional and respectful. Avoid emotional or judgmental language - focus on facts and constructive feedback.



Be consistent.

Store documentation in the same place each time. One Note is a great place for this. Always send documentation to the employee to memorialize the conversation, provide notice, and allow opportunities to resolve the issue.



From Discord to Harmony: Resources

Videoconferencing tips



Check your tech.

Make sure your internet connection, microphone, speakers, and camera are working properly before the meeting. Technical issues can disrupt the flow and add unnecessary stress.



Minimize distractions.

- Use a clean, neutral background
- Turn off notifications on your computer and phone.
- Mute yourself when not speaking and consider wearing noise-canceling headphones.



Cameras on.

- Keeping cameras on allows you to read nonverbal cues and maintain a personal connection.
- Sit up straight and make eye contact with the camera when appropriate.



Leverage screen sharing.

Use screen sharing to present documents, charts, or other visual aids that can help illustrate your points more clearly and keep everyone on the same page.



Avoid multitasking.

- Give the conversation your undivided attention.
- Close other applications and silence your cell phone to remain fully engaged.



From Discord to Harmony: Resources

When an employee reacts emotionally



Remain calm and relax
your body language.



Keep your voice steady
and calm.



Actively listen to show
empathy.



Gently shift the focus
toward solutions.



Respect personal space
and requests for a pause.

When to involve HR & what to handle on your own

Human Resources

- Serious misconduct
- Complex conflicts
- Employee complaints about management
- Need for impartial investigation

On your own

- Performance-related issues
- Interpersonal conflicts
- Work-related disputes
- Attendance issues
- Team dynamic issues
- Minor policy violations